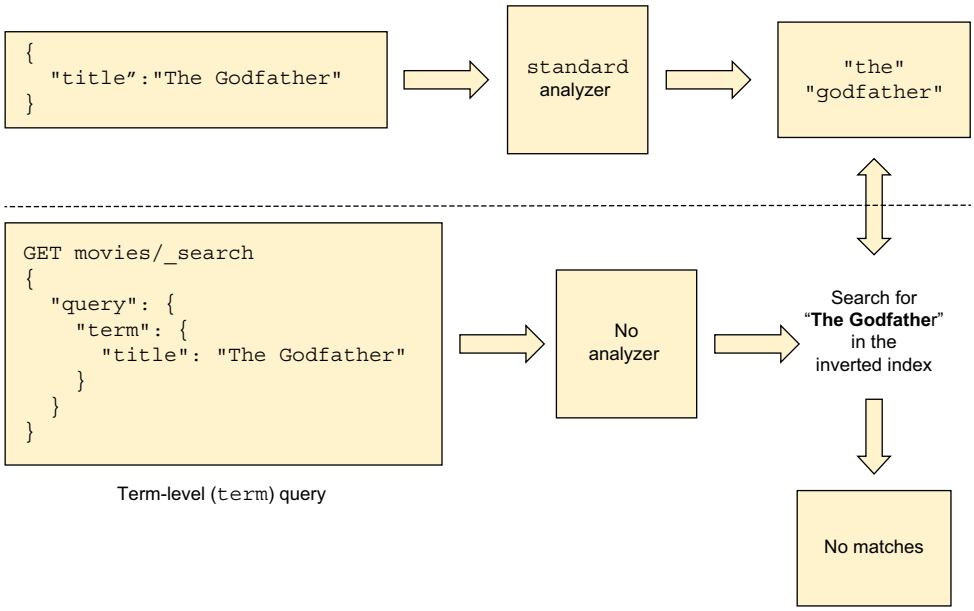


Figure 9.1 Indexing and term-level searching for the movie *The Godfather*

As the figure shows, there are two processes: indexing the document and searching for the document. If the field is a `text` field, assuming the `standard` analyzer is applied, the title is broken into two tokens and lowercased `["the" "godfather"]` during the indexing process.

On the other hand, during a term-level search, search terms are passed as is, without any text analysis. If a term-level query searches for "The Godfather", the engine attempts to search for the exact string "The Godfather" in the inverted index.

We can still run term-level queries on `text` fields, although it's not advisable on fields with lengthy text. We can also use term-level queries if the text has enumerations like days of the week, movie certificates, gender, and so on. If we are indexing gender, such as male and female, term-level queries must use "male" and "female" to successfully return any results because of the `standard` analyzer's activity during the indexing process. The takeaway is that term-level queries search for *exact* words.

Elasticsearch exposes several term-level queries, including `term`, `terms`, `ids`, `fuzzy`, `exists`, `range`, and others. We examine a few important ones in the next section and then present hands-on examples.

NOTE We indexed the sample movie data in chapter 8, and we build all our queries based on that data. For completeness, the source code for this chapter provides the steps to index the movie mapping and sample data.